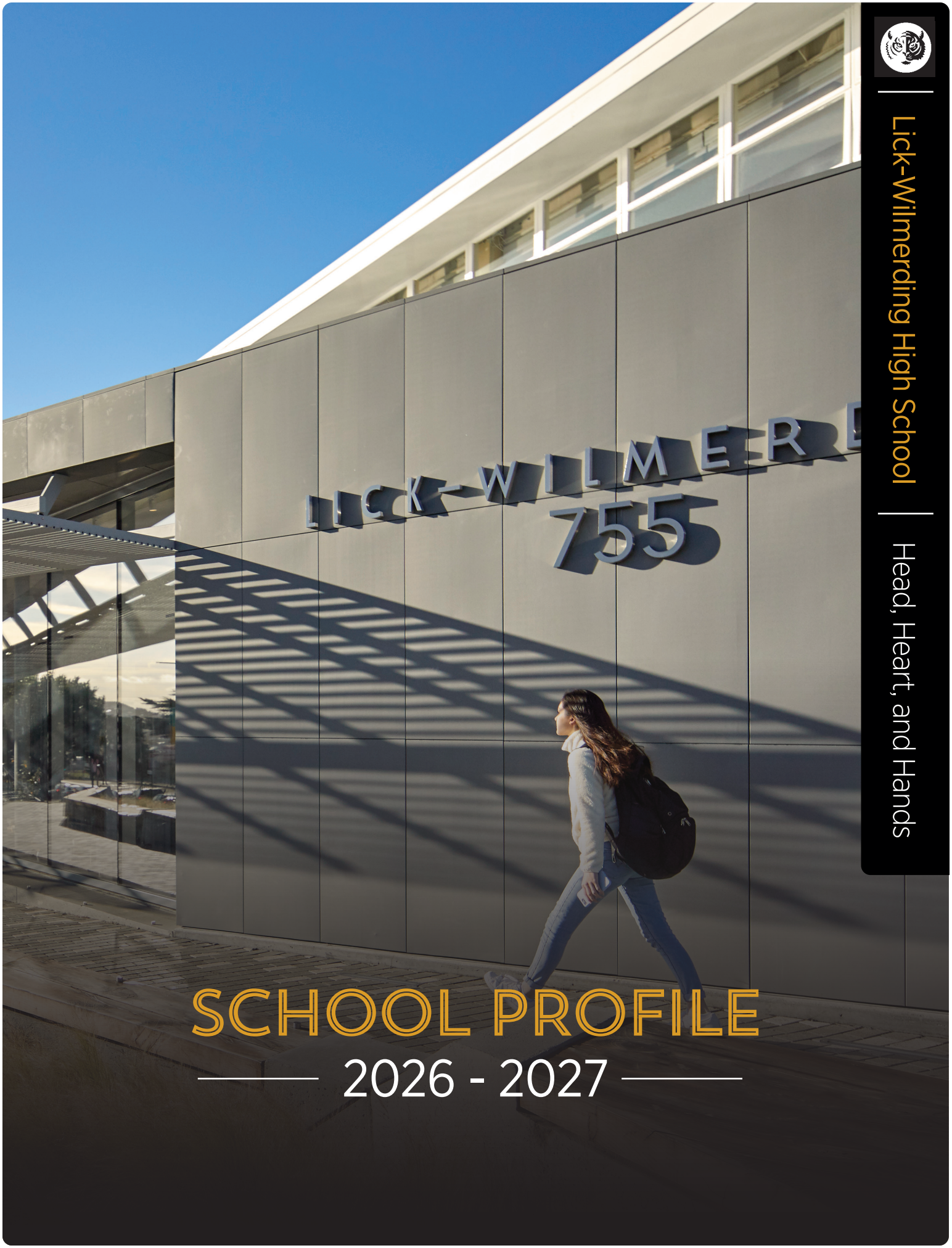


Lick-Wilmerding High School

Head, Heart, and Hands

SCHOOL PROFILE

2026 - 2027



Lick-Wilmerding High School is a **nonprofit**, **independent**, **coeducational**, **college preparatory** day school serving **grades 9–12** with a tradition of integrating demanding academic courses with **technical**, **performing**, and **fine arts**.

The School

Endowed by San Francisco entrepreneur James Lick, the California School of Mechanical Arts opened its doors in 1895. Subsequently, the "Lick School" merged with the Wilmerding School of Industrial Arts and the Lux School of Industrial Training.

The 560 students at LWHS reflect the school's strong commitment to cultural, social, and socioeconomic diversity. First generation-to-college students typically make up between 7% to 14% of a class. The enrolled student body at LWHS is 11% African American, 46% Asian (including East and South Asian), 17% Latinx; 5% Middle Eastern/Middle Eastern American, 3% Native American, 2% Pacific Islander, and 58% white, with 41% of identifying as multiracial. In all, 73% of the student body identify as students of color.

This year, the Flexible Tuition Program has awarded nearly $8 million to more than 33% of enrolled students.

Grading and Class Rank

Grade point average (GPA) is calculated on a 4-point scale using all courses that receive a grade (Body Mind Education, Independent Studies, and Teaching Assistantships are pass/not pass), and the GPA is cumulative from fall semester of ninth grade. Grades are unweighted, students are not ranked, and we do not give any academic awards.

70+
ZIP CODES
REPRESENTED



73%
STUDENTS OF COLOR



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560
TOTAL ENROLLMENT

Lick-Wilmerding High School is more selective than any other Bay Area independent high school, receiving between 900 - 1000 applications annually. The 139 students in the Class of 2027 are highly motivated, typically graduating at the top of their middle schools. Differences in GPA are often miniscule and influenced by factors outside of a student's control such as course availability, prior educational preparation, neurodiversity, personal health/well-being, and family context.

As the school's unique "Head, Heart, Hands" curriculum continues to evolve into the 21st century, it becomes increasingly clear that GPA is a superficial, inadequate measure of the achievement and potential of LWHS students. Therefore, LWHS has chosen not to publicize GPA distribution in order to more closely align with the school mission, to encourage colleges to maintain the integrity of the holistic review process, and to celebrate students' individuality.



Public Purpose Program

As a private school with public purpose, LWHS places service and community engagement at the heart of education. The four-year Public Purpose Program enables students to live our mission by meaningfully connecting with local, national, and global communities. This scaffolded program helps students recognize how to apply their education and unique talents to create positive change and advance social justice.

Technical Arts at LWHS

In "the shops," students explore the intersection of design, engineering, and craft through Technical Arts courses in Coding, Electronics, Jewelry, Woodworking, Sewing, and Metal and Digital Fabrication. They learn to design, prototype, and build while developing project management skills, teamwork, persistence, and craftsmanship—discovering joy, confidence, and meaning through hands-on creation.



150+
MIDDLE SCHOOLS REPRESENTED

College Matriculation

Each year, 98 - 100% of LWHS graduates attend four-year colleges or universities; others will take a gap or attend a community college. LWHS students from the past four years attend the following schools:

American University	2
Amherst College	3
Amsterdam University College	1
Azusa Pacific University	1
Babson College	1
Bard College	1
Barnard College	9
Bates College	2
Baylor University	1
Boston College	1
Boston University	6
Bowdoin College	2
Brandeis University	1
Brown University	5
Bryn Mawr College	1
California Baptist University	1
California Lutheran University	1
California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo	15
California State Polytechnic University, Pomona	2
Carleton College	5
Carnegie Mellon University	3
Case Western Reserve University	1
Claremont McKenna College	4
Cleveland Institute of Music	1
Colgate University	4
Colorado College	4
Colorado School of Mines	2
Columbia University	8
Cooper Union for the Advancement of Science and Art	1
Cornell University	11
Dartmouth College	7
Denison University	1
Diablo Valley College	1
Duke University	2
Emory University	5
ESADE Business School	1
Fashion Institute of Technology	1
Fordham University	1
Georgetown University	6
Georgia Institute of Technology	1
Grinnell College	1
Gustavus Adolphus College	1
Hamilton College	1
Hampton University	1
Harvard University	5
Harvey Mudd College	4
Haverford College	1
Howard University	4
Indiana University Bloomington	1
Johns Hopkins University	3
Lehigh University	1
Lewis & Clark College	2
Loyola Marymount University	1
Loyola University Maryland	1
Macalester College	1
Massachusetts Institute of Technology	3
McGill University	6
Middlebury College	1
Montclair State University	1
New York University	12
North Carolina Central University	1
Northeastern University	17
Northwestern University	11
Occidental College	3
Pitzer College	6
Pomona College	7
Pratt Institute	1
Princeton University	7
Purdue University	4
Reed College	2
Rhode Island School of Design	1
Rice University	2
San Diego State University	3
San Francisco State University	1
Santa Barbara City College	1
Santa Clara University	2
Savannah College of Art and Design	2
Scripps College	7
Seattle Pacific University	1
Seattle University	1
Skidmore College	1
Smith College	1
Southern Methodist University	1
St. John's College, Annapolis	1
St. Lawrence University	1
Stanford University	21
Syracuse University	1
The Culinary Institute of America	1
The George Washington University	3
The University of Arizona	4
The University of British Columbia	6
The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill	6
Trinity College Dublin	1
Tufts University	9
Tulane University	5
United States Air Force Academy	1
University of California	
Los Angeles	20
Berkeley	38
Davis	4
Irvine	6
Riverside	1
San Diego	1
Santa Barbara	5
Santa Cruz	9
University of Chicago	4
University of Connecticut	1
University of Denver	1
University of Hawaii at Manoa	1
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign	6
University of Miami	2
University of Michigan	12
University of Oregon	5
University of Pennsylvania	9
University of Puget Sound	1
University of Richmond	1
University of Rochester	1
University of San Diego	1
University of San Francisco	5
University of Southern California	12
University of St Andrews	4
University of Strathclyde	1
University of Toronto	3
University of Vermont	1
University of Virginia	2
University of Washington	11
University of Wisconsin, Madison	3
Vanderbilt University	2
Vassar College	3
Washington University in St. Louis	13
Wellesley College	8
Wesleyan University	10
William & Mary	2
Williams College	2
Yale University	11

Lick-Wilmerding High School is fully accredited by the Western Association of Schools and Colleges and is a member of the National Association of Independent Schools, the National Association for College Admission Counseling and People of Color in Independent Schools.

Course Requirements and Offerings

Below, please find the courses offered over the past four years; note that every course is not offered every semester or year. All current course offerings are listed online at ***lwhs.org/academic/course-catalog***

Curriculum

The maximum number of courses a student may carry (beyond ninth grade) per semester is seven. Students may take only five courses designated "a–e" (the admission requirements for California's public universities) from each of these departments: History (a), English (b), Math (c), Science (d), and World Language (e).

In keeping with LWHS' 130-year tradition, every student is required to complete two years of technical arts courses and participate annually in the Public Purpose Program (PPP), a hands-on education/service experience. LWHS does not offer AP courses; faculty have designed high-level and demanding Honors courses that offer rigor and depth over coverage and breadth.

English

(4 years required)

- English 1
- English 2
- English 3H
- English 4H: Seminars
- English: Creative Writing

History & Social Studies

(3 years required)

- Modern World History
- U.S. History H
- Modern U.S. History Senior Seminars
- Modern World History Senior Seminars

Mathematics

(3 years required)

- Algebra 1
- Algebra 2
- Algebra 2 Acc
- Calculus H
- Calculus PPP
- Deductive Geometry
- Inductive Geometry
- Precalculus
- Precalculus H
- Precalculus H PPP

Performing Arts

(1 semester required)

- Acting
- Advanced Jazz & Contemporary Music Ensemble PPP
- Advanced Creative Projects in Music Production
- Advanced Stagecraft
- Chamber Orchestra PPP
- Creative Projects in Music Production
- Dance 1
- Dance 2
- Dance Ensemble PPP
- Drawing & Painting
- Improv PPP
- Sketch Comedy & Improv
- Jazz & Contemporary Music Ensemble
- Music & Social Justice PPP
- Music and the Brain
- Songwriting 1
- Songwriting 2
- Stagecraft
- Vocal Ensemble PPP

Science

(3 years required)

- Biology (9th grade required)
- Biology H: Anatomy & Physiology (not offered 2023-24)
- Biology H: Behavioral Genetics & Anthropology
- Biology H: Marine Ecology: Field & Lab Science PPP
- Biology H: Molecular Genetics
- Chemistry (10th grade required)
- Chemistry H
- Environmental Science H
- Ethics in the Sciences & Technology
- Honors Bio: Neuroscience and Psychology
- Honors Bio: Science Research Fly Sci PPP
- Music & the Brain
- Physics
- Physics H: Mechanics
- Physics H: Modern Physics
- Psychology: Brain & Behavior
- Psychology: Brain & Behavior PPP

Technical Arts

(2 years required)

- Computer Science & Engineering: 3D Printing
- Computer Science & Engineering: Circuits & Electronics 1
- Computer Science & Engineering: Circuits & Electronics 2
- Computer Science & Engineering: Graphics & Game Design
- Computer Science & Engineering: Community Computing PPP
- Design & Technology (9th grade required)
- Metalsmithing: Jewelry 1
- Metalsmithing: Jewelry 2
- Private Skills for a Public Purpose PPP
- Rethinking Furniture
- Textile Arts 1
- Textile Arts 2
- Wood: Joinery & Turning

Visual Arts

(1 year required)

- Advanced Architectural Design
- Architectural Design
- Architectural Design 3
- Contemporary Media & Art (9th grade required)
- Drawing & Painting
- Film: Cinematic Storytelling PPP
- Mixed Media
- Photography 1
- Photography 2 PPP
- Studio Art – Painting

World Languages

(3 years of one language, or 2 years each of 2 languages required)

- Chinese (Mandarin) 1, 2, 3, 4H, 5/6H PPP
- French 1, 2, 3, 4H
- Spanish 1, 2, 2 Acc, 3, 3H, 4, 4H, 5H

BlendEd

(Electives that combine online learning with face-to-face interactions)

- Abnormal Psychology
- Ancient Greek
- Applied AI in Python
- Bioethics
- Honors Future Cities: Civic Technology, Data & Design
- Incarceration Nation: The Rise of the U.S. Prison Industrial Complex
- Meaning of Life: Philosophy & Lit
- Movements for Change
- The Science of Sci-Fi
- Zen in the Bay: A Holistic Exploration of Buddhist Meditation & Practice

Other Opportunities & Requirements

- Body Mind Education (9th grade required)
- Ethnic Studies
- Freshman PPP (9th grade required)
- Independent Study
- Independent Study PPP
- Internship PPP
- Journalism PPP
- Junior Public Purpose Project
- Leadership in Action PPP
- Senior Public Purpose Project
- Sophomore Health: Human Sexuality (10th grade required)
- Sophomore PPP (10th grade required)
- Teaching Assistantship

H = Honors class, Acc = Accelerated class, PPP = courses with additional requirements as part of LWHS' Public Purpose Program.

Lick-Wilmerding's Mission Statement

A private school with public purpose, Lick-Wilmerding High School develops the head, heart, and hands of highly motivated students from all walks of life, inspiring them to become life-long learners who contribute to the world with confidence and compassion.

Lick-Wilmerding's Core Values

We are a diverse, inclusive and intentional community that values:

BELONGING • EXCELLENCE • CRAFT • OPTIMISM

LICK-WILMERDING
18 HIGH SCHOOL 95

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